Building Inclusion at ECRS

Choose materials and structure your class or activity to:

- include everyone
- respect everyone
- celebrate differences
- dispel stereotypes
- affirm the worth of all people

Avoid:

- materials that carry a history of persecution (*e.g.,* "Pick a Bale o' Cotton")
- outdated language to refer to a group of people (*e.g.,* "mentally retarded"…"handicapped"…"American Indian")
- materials that leave out a group of people (*e.g.,* religious songs)
- materials that are taken out of context (*e.g.,* a dance that is part of a sacred ritual)
- jokes about a marginalized group (*e.g.,* imitating stereotypes about gay men)
- language appropriated from a marginalized group about themselves

Avoid or modify:

- language that excludes marginalized groups (*e.g.,* "the room was filled with men" … "brothers and sisters")
- language that offends or denigrates a group of people (*e.g.,* "gypsy")
- materials that reinforce stereotypes (*e.g.,* "When I first came to this land…I got myself a wife")
- materials that are not accessible to all (*e.g.,* activities that cannot be modified for physical or cognitive differences)
- materials that do not honor a group's traditions (*e.g.,* a dance taken out of context)

Learn about marginalized groups:

- current language that works for them—ex., neurodivergent, differently abled, deaf…
- "micro"aggressions you may not be aware of
- Watch the 4 ½ minute video "LISTEN: How do you respond to microaggressions?" https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=C3LFB4mJ0DI

When you realize you have had a negative impact:

- "I am so sorry what I did/said/chose had that impact on you."
- "Thank you for letting me know."
- "I will not make that mistake again."
- "Is there something that would work better for you?"
- "Please continue to let me know if I do/say/choose something that is offensive or not inclusive in the future."

Patricia Day Williams • www.patriciadaywilliams.com • Tel. (703) 472-3888 • pdw@patriciadaywilliams.com